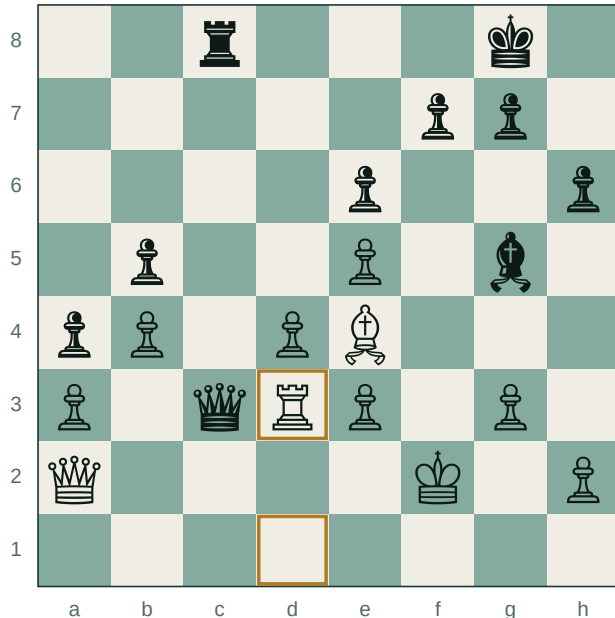


Clearance tactics: Black, move 36

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Rd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Qc1 37. Rd2 Rc3

36...Qc1 The queen moves from c3 to c1. Recorded reply: **37.Rd2**.

37...Rc3 The rook moves from c8 to c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e4 and queen on a2. Check for tactical protection.